

Word family: **draw / draws / drew / drawn / drawing / drawer**

Base word: draw

Past tense: drew

Past participle: drawn

Related forms: drawing, drawer

Useful expressions / extensions: draw a picture, draw a line, draw attention, draw a conclusion, draw a comparison, draw someone in, draw near, draw lots

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / noun-related forms (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, **drawing imaginary cities**, or folding paper rockets...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **draw** means:

> **to make a picture or visual representation using a pencil, pen, crayon, etc.**

Leo is imagining cities and putting those ideas onto paper.

繁體中文： ** 用筆等在紙面上畫出圖像、形狀或想像中的事物

**中文翻譯： **

> “He can spend hours ... drawing imaginary cities...”

「他可以花幾個小時.....**畫一些想像出來的城市**.....」

Here:

draw imaginary cities = 把腦中的城市構想畫在紙上

1. **draw = make a picture (畫) — 畫；繪畫**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He can spend hours **drawing imaginary cities**.”

「他可以花幾個小時**畫想像中的城市**。」

Practice 2

> “She likes to **draw** animals.”

「她喜歡**畫動物**。」

Practice 3

> “The child **drew** a house with a garden.”

「那個小朋友**畫**了一間有花園的房子。」

draw = 用筆、鉛筆、蠟筆等在平面上畫出圖像、形狀或物件

2. **draw** = make a line/shape (畫線 / 形狀) — 畫 ; 劃

Practice 4

> “**Draw** a straight line across the page.”

「在紙上**畫**一條直線。」

Practice 5

> “She **drew** a circle around the answer.”

「她在答案外面**畫**了一個圓圈。」

draw = 用筆等畫出線條、輪廓或幾何形狀

3. **draw** = design/sketch something (繪製草圖) — 畫草圖 ; 設計

Practice 6

> “The architect **drew** a plan of the building.”

「建築師**畫**了大樓的平面圖。」

Practice 7

> “He **drew** a rough design for the bridge.”

「他為那座橋**畫了一個初步設計圖**。」

****draw = 把設計、結構或構想以圖像形式表示出來****

4. ****draw = pull something toward yourself (拉) — 拉 ; 拖****

A major separate meaning.

Practice 8

> “She ****drew**** the chair closer.”

「她把椅子**拉近**。」

Practice 9

> “He ****drew**** the curtains.”

「他把窗簾**拉上 / 拉開**。」

****draw = 用力把某物拉向某個方向****

This is one of the oldest core meanings of the verb.

5. ****draw = take something out (抽出 / 拔出) — 拔出 ; 抽出****

Practice 10

> “He ****drew**** a knife.”

「他**拔出一把刀**。」

Practice 11

> “She ****drew**** a card from the pack.”

「她從牌堆裡**抽出一張牌**。」

****draw = 從容器、套子、牌堆等中把某物取出****

6. **draw = extract liquid (抽取液體) — 抽取 ; 汲取**

Practice 12

> “They **drew** water from the well.”

「他們從井裡**汲水**。」

Practice 13

> “The nurse **drew** blood from his arm.”

「護士從他的手臂**抽血**。」

draw = 從某個來源抽取液體，例如水或血液

7. **draw = attract attention/interest (吸引) — 吸引 ; 引起**

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 14

> “The unusual design **drew** a lot of attention.”

「那個特別的設計**吸引了很多注意**。」

Practice 15

> “The event **drew** a large crowd.”

「這個活動**吸引了大批人群**。」

draw = 令某人或某事受到注意、興趣或人群聚集

8. **draw attention to (引起注意) — 提醒注意 ; 使人注意**

Practice 16

> “The report **draws attention to** several problems.”

「這份報告**指出並引起人們注意**幾個問題。」

Practice 17

> “She **drew** my attention to **a mistake.**”

「她**提醒我注意**一個錯誤。」

draw attention to = 使別人注意某人、某事或某個問題

9. **draw interest/support** (吸引興趣 / 支持) — 吸引 ; 獲得

Practice 18

> “The proposal **drew** strong support.”

「這項建議**獲得了大量支持**。」

Practice 19

> “The exhibition **drew** international interest.”

「這個展覽**吸引了國際關注**。」

draw = 令興趣、支持或反應被吸引過來

10. **draw** = move gradually toward something (靠近) — 接近 ; 靠近

A useful intransitive sense.

Practice 20

> “The train **drew** closer to the station.”

「火車逐漸**接近車站**。」

Practice 21

> “Night was **drawing** near.”

「夜晚逐漸**來臨**。」

draw + nearer/closer = 漸漸接近某地、某時刻或某狀態

11. **draw near / draw close (臨近) — 接近；臨近**

Practice 22

> “As winter **draws near**, the days become shorter.”

「隨著冬天**臨近**，白晝變短。」

Practice 23

> “The deadline is **drawing close**.”

「截止日期正在**逼近**。」

draw near/close = 某個時間、事件或地點逐漸接近

12. **draw = cause someone to move/come closer (吸引靠近) — 吸引；引來**

Practice 24

> “The music **drew** people into the room.”

「音樂把人們**吸引進房間**。」

Practice 25

> “The smell of food **drew** the children closer.”

「食物的香味把孩子們**吸引過來**。」

draw someone somewhere = 以某種吸引力令某人靠近、進入或前往某處

13. **draw = derive/get from a source (汲取) — 從……獲得；汲取**

A major abstract extension.

Practice 26

> “She **draws strength from** her family.”

「她從家人身上**汲取力量**。」

Practice 27

> “He **drew inspiration from** nature.”

「他從大自然中**獲得靈感**。」

draw something from X = 從某個來源取得力量、靈感、資訊或好處

14. **draw on = use a resource/experience (利用) — 利用；運用**

A very common phrasal extension.

Practice 28

> “She **drew on** her experience as a teacher.”

「她**運用了**自己作為老師的經驗。」

Practice 29

> “The writer **draws on** childhood memories.”

「作者**取材自 / 運用**童年回憶。」

draw on something = 利用已有的經驗、知識、資源或記憶

15. **draw a conclusion (得出結論) — 得出；作出結論**

A major abstract construction.

Practice 30

> “It is too early to **draw a conclusion**.”

「現在要**下結論**還太早。」

Practice 31

> “What conclusion can we **draw** from the data?”

「我們可以從這些數據**得出甚麼結論**？」

****draw a conclusion = 根據證據、資料或觀察推導出判斷****

16. ****draw an inference (作出推論) — 推斷；推論****

Practice 32

> “We can ****draw an inference**** from the results.”

「我們可以從結果**作出推論**。」

Practice 33

> “It is difficult to ****draw firm inferences**** from one example.”

「只靠一個例子很難**作出可靠推論**。」

****draw an inference = 根據已知資訊推導出未直接說明的意思 / 結果****

17. ****draw a comparison (作比較) — 比較；作出對比****

Practice 34

> “The article ****draws a comparison**** between the two systems.”

「文章**比較了**兩個系統。」

Practice 35

> “It is useful to ****draw comparisons**** between the two approaches.”

「把兩種方法**作比較**很有用。」

****draw a comparison = 把兩個或以上的事物並列，指出相似或不同之處****

18. ****draw a distinction (作出區分) — 區分；劃分界線****

Practice 36

> “We need to **draw a distinction** between the two meanings.”

「我們需要**區分**這兩個意思。」

Practice 37

> “The law **draws a clear distinction** between the two cases.”

「法律對這兩種情況作出**清晰區分**。」

draw a distinction = 明確指出兩個概念、情況或類別之間的差別

19. **draw a line** (劃界線 / 設定界限) — 劃線 ; 設界限

Literal and figurative.

Practice 38

> “She **drew a line** across the page.”

「她在紙上**畫了一條線**。」

Practice 39

> “We have to **draw the line** somewhere.”

「我們總要在某個地方**劃下界線 / 設定限度**。」

draw a line = 畫線 ; 亦比喻設定不可再超越的界限

20. **draw the line at** (拒絕接受到某程度) — 劃底線 ; 拒絕再進一步

Practice 40

> “I don’t mind helping, but I **draw the line at** doing all the work.”

「我不介意幫忙，但要我做所有工作就**超出我的底線了**。」

Practice 41

> “She **draws the line at** dishonesty.”

「她對不誠實的行為**絕不接受**。」

****draw the line at X = 設定可接受範圍的界線，拒絕超過某個程度****

21. ****draw lots (抽籤) — 抽籤****

Practice 42

> “We ****drew lots**** to decide who would go first.”

「我們****抽籤****決定誰先去。」

Practice 43

> “The teams ****drew lots**** for their positions.”

「各隊****抽籤****決定位置。」

****draw lots = 以隨機抽取方式作決定****

22. ****draw a card/number/name (抽取) — 抽；抽出****

Practice 44

> “She ****drew**** a number from the box.”

「她從盒子裡****抽出一個號碼****。」

Practice 45

> “His name was ****drawn**** first.”

「他的名字最先被****抽中****。」

****draw = 從一組項目中隨機抽取一個****

23. ****draw = sports result with equal score (打和) — 打成平手****

A major sports meaning, especially in British English.

Practice 46

> “The teams ****drew**** 1–1.”

「兩隊以 1 比 1 ****打和****。」

Practice 47

> “They ****drew with**** the league leaders.”

「他們與聯賽榜首球隊****打成平手****。」

****draw = 比賽結束時雙方得分相同，沒有勝負****

24. ****draw = noun: tied game/result (和局) — 平手；和局****

Practice 48

> “The match ended in a ****draw****.”

「比賽以****和局****結束。」

Practice 49

> “A ****draw**** was enough to keep them in the competition.”

「一場****和局****已足以讓他們留在比賽中。」

****draw = 雙方得分相同、沒有勝負的比賽結果****

25. ****draw = lottery/selection event (抽籤 / 抽獎) — 抽籤；抽獎****

Another noun meaning.

Practice 50

> “The prize ****draw**** will take place tomorrow.”

「****抽獎****明天舉行。」

Practice 51

> “The tournament **draw** was announced today.”

「賽事的**抽籤結果 / 籤表**今天公布。」

draw = 以隨機方式選出號碼、人或比賽配對的活動 / 結果

26. **draw** = something that attracts people (吸引人的事物) — 吸引力；賣點

Practice 52

> “The beach is the area’s biggest **draw**.”

「海灘是這個地區最大的**吸引力 / 賣點**。」

Practice 53

> “The famous singer was the main **draw**.”

「那位著名歌手是活動的主要**吸引力**。」

draw = 能吸引觀眾、遊客或顧客的人 / 事物

27. **drawing** = picture made by drawing (圖畫) — 圖畫；素描

Practice 54

> “Leo showed me a **drawing** of a city.”

「Leo 給我看一幅城市**圖畫**。」

Practice 55

> “The child’s **drawing** was full of detail.”

「那個小朋友的**畫作**有很多細節。」

drawing = 用筆、鉛筆等畫成的圖像 / 作品

28. **drawing** = act/skill of drawing (繪畫) — 繪畫；素描

Practice 56

> “She is good at ****drawing****.”

「她很擅長****畫畫****。」

Practice 57

> “The course teaches basic ****drawing****.”

「這個課程教授基本****素描 / 繪畫技巧****。」

****drawing = 畫圖這項活動、技能或藝術形式****

29. ****drawing = technical plan (工程 / 建築圖) — 圖則 ; 工程圖****

Practice 58

> “The engineer checked the technical ****drawings****.”

「工程師檢查了技術****圖則****。」

Practice 59

> “The contractor followed the architect’s ****drawings****.”

「承建商按照建築師的****圖則****施工。」

****drawing = 顯示物件、建築或機械結構和尺寸的技術圖則****

30. ****drawer = sliding storage compartment (抽屜) — 抽屜****

A historically related but now lexicalized family member.

Practice 60

> “The keys are in the top ****drawer****.”

「鎖匙在最上面的****抽屜****裡。」

Practice 61

> “She opened the desk ****drawer****.”

「她打開書桌的****抽屜****。」

****drawer = 家具中可拉出和推回、用來存放物品的盒狀部分****

Important pronunciation:

> ****drawer**** is usually pronounced roughly like “draw-er,” often compressed in natural speech.

31. ****drawer = person who draws (畫圖的人) — 繪圖者****

This is grammatically possible, but much less common.

Practice 62

> “He is a skilled ****drawer****.”

「他是一個熟練的****繪圖者****。」

Practice 63

> “The better ****drawer**** completed the sketch quickly.”

「較擅長繪畫的人很快完成了草圖。」

****drawer = 畫圖的人****

However, everyday English strongly prefers:

* artist

* illustrator

* sketch artist

depending on context.

So this is low-priority learner vocabulary.

Important distinction: ****draw vs paint****

****draw****

usually uses:

- * pencil
- * pen
- * charcoal
- * lines

paint

uses:

- * paint
- * brushes
- * colour applied to a surface

> “draw a picture”

vs:

> “paint a picture.”

A person can draw first and paint later.

Important distinction: **draw vs sketch**

draw

is broad.

sketch

usually means:

> make a quick, rough drawing without full detail.

> “She drew the building.”

could be detailed.

> “She sketched the building.”

suggests a quicker rough version.

Important distinction: **draw vs design**

draw

= visually represent something.

design

= plan how something should look/work.

You can design something without physically drawing it.

And you can draw something that you did not design.

Important distinction: **draw vs write**

draw

creates images, lines, diagrams, shapes.

write

creates words, letters, numbers, or text.

Children may:

> draw a house

but:

> write their name.

Important distinction: **draw vs pull**

These overlap in the physical sense.

pull

is the ordinary general verb:

> "Pull the door."

draw

in the pulling sense is more restricted and often appears in established collocations:

- * draw the curtains
- * draw a sword
- * draw something closer

So **pull** is usually broader in everyday physical action.

Important distinction: **draw a curtain vs close a curtain**

draw the curtains

= move the curtains across the window, usually to close them.

close the curtains

= make them closed.

Draw emphasizes the pulling movement; **close** emphasizes the resulting state.

Important distinction: **draw blood vs take blood**

draw blood

= extract blood, especially medically.

take blood

is also common in British medical English.

Both can mean 抽血, though **draw blood** has another figurative/physical possibility:

> injure someone enough to make them bleed.

Important distinction: **draw attention vs attract attention**

These are very close.

draw attention

often means:

> cause attention to move toward something.

attract attention

emphasizes:

> something naturally or deliberately causes people to notice it.

Both are common.

Important distinction: **draw attention to vs point out**

draw attention to

= make someone notice something.

point out

= explicitly mention/show a specific fact or detail.

> “She drew attention to the issue.”

can be general.

> “She pointed out the error.”

explicitly identifies it.

Important distinction: **draw from vs take from**

draw from

often means:

> derive inspiration, strength, information, or ideas from a source.

take from

is broader and can be literal or abstract.

> “draw inspiration from nature”

sounds natural and conceptual.

Important distinction: **draw on vs depend on**

draw on

= actively use an available resource.

depend on

= require/rely on it.

> “She drew on her experience.”

= 她運用了經驗。

> “She depended on her experience.”

= 她依賴經驗。

Subtle but important.

Important distinction: **draw a conclusion vs make a conclusion**

Standard English prefers:

> **draw/reach a conclusion** 

rather than:

> **make a conclusion**  in most ordinary contexts.

This is a useful collocational point.

Important distinction: **draw a comparison vs compare**

compare A and B

direct verb construction.

draw a comparison between A and B

noun-based, slightly more formal.

Both mean:

> 把兩者作比較.

Important distinction: **draw a distinction vs tell the difference**

draw a distinction

= explicitly establish a conceptual difference.

tell the difference

= recognize that two things differ.

The first is analytical; the second is perceptual/cognitive.

Important distinction: **draw = tie vs win/lose**

In sports:

draw

= no winner; equal score.

win

= finish ahead.

lose

= finish behind.

So:

> draw ≠ almost win

It specifically means equal result.

Important distinction: **draw — sports vs draw — lottery**

Sports:

> “The game ended in a draw.”

= 和局

Lottery:

> “The prize draw is tomorrow.”

= 抽獎

Same spelling, completely different noun meanings.

Important distinction: **draw — attraction vs draw — drawing**

Attraction:

> “The beach is a big draw.”

= 海灘很有吸引力。

Picture:

> “She made a drawing.”

= 她畫了一幅畫。

The noun **draw** itself does not normally mean “picture”; **drawing** does.

Important distinction: **drawing vs painting**

drawing

usually emphasizes lines/marks.

painting

uses paint and colour as the main medium.

A work can combine both, but they are distinct art forms.

Family-extension note

Draw is a very strong polysemy word.

Its major semantic centres include:

- * **make a picture/line**
- * **pull**
- * **take/extract**
- * **attract**
- * **move closer**
- * **derive from a source**
- * **infer** → draw a conclusion
- * **distinguish/compare**
- * **randomly select**
- * **sports tie**
- * **noun: attraction**
- * **noun: lottery/selection**
- * **drawing — artwork/skill/technical plan**

The family sweep also catches:

- * **drawing**
- * **drawer**

The key is to keep truly different semantic centres separate while not over-splitting every predictable collocation such as **draw a circle**, **draw a line**, and **draw a picture** if they share the same visual-creation core. That matches the manual's "search broadly, split conservatively" rule.

Master comparison

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draw — picture	用筆、鉛筆等在平面上畫出圖像、形狀或物件	
draw — line/shape	畫出線條、輪廓或幾何形狀	
draw — design/sketch	把設計、結構或構想以圖像形式表示出來	
draw — pull	把某物拉向某個方向	
draw — extract/remove	從容器、套子或某來源中把某物取出	
draw — liquid	從某個來源抽取水、血液等液體	
draw — attract attention	令某人 / 某事受到注意或興趣	
draw attention to	使別人注意某人、某事或問題	
draw support/interest	吸引或獲得支持、興趣或反應	
draw near/close	漸漸接近某個時間、地點或事件	
draw someone somewhere	以吸引力令某人靠近或前往某處	
draw from	從某個來源取得力量、靈感、資訊或好處	
draw on	利用已有的經驗、知識、記憶或資源	
draw a conclusion	根據證據或資料推導出判斷	
draw an inference	根據已知資訊作出推論	
draw a comparison	把兩個或以上事物並列作比較	
draw a distinction	明確指出兩個概念 / 類別之間的差別	
draw the line	設定不可再超越的界限 / 底線	
draw lots	以隨機抽取方式作決定	
draw a card/name/number	從一組項目中隨機抽取一個	
draw — sports verb	比賽雙方最終得分相同	
draw — sports noun	沒有勝負、雙方得分相同的比賽結果	
draw — lottery/selection noun	以隨機方式選出號碼、人或配對的活動 / 結果	
draw — attraction noun	能吸引觀眾、遊客或顧客的人 / 事物	
drawing — artwork	用筆等畫成的圖像或作品	
drawing — activity/skill	畫圖這項活動、技能或藝術形式	
drawing — technical plan	顯示物件、建築或機械結構和尺寸的技術圖則	
drawer — furniture	家具中可拉出和推回、用來存放物品的盒狀部分	

For your original sentence

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, **drawing imaginary cities**, or folding paper rockets...”

The exact meaning is:

draw = 用筆等把腦中的圖像、構想或物件畫在紙上

Therefore:

> **drawing imaginary cities**

= **「把自己想像出來的城市畫出來」**

The important nuance is that Leo is not merely copying something he sees.

He is:

> imagining → visualizing → drawing

So this is the **visual-creation sense** of **draw**, not:

* **draw the curtains** = 拉窗簾

* **draw blood** = 抽血

* **draw attention** = 吸引注意

* **draw a conclusion** = 得出結論

* **draw 1-1** = 打和

In the passage, **draw** is the straightforward **make-a-picture sense**, but it also reinforces Leo's imaginative and creative personality.